

Fearsome forks
Forked lightning is the name for lightning that appears as jagged lines of light split into several branches.

Ground strikes
Cloud-to-ground lightning strikes tall things, such as trees and buildings. The powerful electric current can cause great damage and set things on fire.

Lightning strikes last a fraction of a second.

Sparking clouds

Not all lightning strikes reach the ground. Cloud-to-cloud lightning happens when huge sparks of electricity leap across the sky from one storm cloud to another. These huge flashes of light are known as sheet lightning.

Quick quiz



How hot is a flash of lightning?



Why does lightning create thunder?



What is sheet lightning?

